Cybersecurity for Kids

Joas A Santos

About PDF

- Welcome to the fascinating world of cybersecurity! This book is a special adventure, designed to help you, young digital explorer, safely navigate the vast and exciting seas of the internet. Like a true web detective, you will learn to unravel the mysteries of online security, protecting yourself from cyber hackers and traps hidden on the network.
- This is a book for parents to use with their children, with content focused on the basics of digital protection.

Creator: https://www.linkedin.com/in/joas-antonio-dos-santos/

Vírus/Malwares

- Mal-wa-res is a short word for "malicious software," which means computer programs that are made to cause harm or do bad things to computers and other devices, such as cell phones. It's like a virus that can make a computer sick. People who create malware may try to steal information, such as your game passwords or personal data about you such as your name, home address and the like, or even cause your computer to stop working properly.

Vírus/Malwares - Example

- Imagine you are playing Minecraft or Roblox, which are games where you can build things and explore different worlds. Malware would be like someone who enters your game without you knowing and starts destroying everything you've built or steals your precious items. This "someone" is not a real person, but a computer program that someone created to cause problems.
- For example, if you download a Minecraft mod from an untrustworthy website, that mod may have malware. Instead of just adding cool things to your game, it can also allow someone to control your computer or steal your information. It's as if, while you're focused on playing, someone invisible is going through your things without you knowing.

Antivírus

- Antivirus is like a superhero for your computer or cell phone. It helps protect your device against "bad guys" called viruses or malware that try to damage your device or steal important information.
- You can think of antivirus as a guard that keeps an eye on everything that enters your computer, such as programs, games or files you download from the internet. If it sees something suspicious or dangerous, like a virus trying to get in, it acts quickly to block that virus and prevent it from causing any problems. The antivirus can also scan all files that are already on your computer to make sure nothing dangerous is hiding there.
- It's like you have a very attentive friend who looks around to make sure everything is safe while you play or do your work on the computer. Thanks to antivirus, you can use your device with greater peace of mind, knowing that someone is helping to protect you and your things.

Email Security

- Let's talk about how to keep your email safe, especially from something called "phishing." Phishing is a trick used by malicious people to try to trick you and steal important information, such as passwords or your family details.
- Imagine you receive an email that appears to be from your favorite online game, telling you that you've won a super cool reward. But to get it, you need to click on a link and enter your password. Sounds fun, right? However, if that email isn't actually from the game but from a phishing scam, clicking on it could lead to bad people knowing your password.

Email Security

To stay safe, here are some tips:

- **Check who sent the email:** Take a close look at the sender's email address. If it seems strange or different from normal, it could be a warning sign.
- **Don't click on suspicious links:** If you are not sure about a link, better not to click. Instead, go directly to the website by typing the address into your browser bar.
- **Ask an Adult:** If you get something unexpected and you're not sure, it's a good idea to show it to an adult before you do anything.

Password Security

A password is like a secret key that only you know and use to log into your online accounts, such as email, games or social networks. It is very important that this key is difficult for others to guess so that no one can access your personal information.

To have a strong password, think of a combination that includes:

- **Uppercase and lowercase letters:** Mix large and small letters.
- **Numbers**: Add some numbers to make the password more difficult.
- **Symbols**: Use symbols like @, #, $, %, which are like special designs on the keyboard.
- **Length**: A long password is generally more secure, so try to make your password at least 8 characters long.
- Don't use things that are easy to guess, like your name, birthday, or very simple words. And remember, it's not good to use the same password for everything; If someone discovers a password, they won't be able to access all of your accounts.
- Thinking about a password can be like creating a secret code that only you know how to decipher!

Safe Internet Browsing

- Browsing the internet can be like exploring a huge amusement park: there are so many amazing places to visit and interesting things to learn. But just like at a park, it's important to follow some safety rules to ensure you have a fun and safe experience.

Here are some tips for safe internet browsing:

- Know the safe ways: Only use trusted websites. You can check whether a site is secure by looking at its address, which should start with "https" — the "s" at the end stands for "secure."
- Keep your personal information safe: Just like you wouldn't give your name, address, or phone number to strangers on the street, don't share this information online unless it's absolutely necessary and the site is trustworthy.

Safe Internet Browsing

- **Beware of strangers:** On the internet, it's not always easy to know who's on the other side of the screen. Don't accept friend requests or respond to messages from people you don't know.
- **Use protection tools**: Install a good antivirus and keep it updated. It will help protect your computer against malicious programs that try to invade your machine or steal your information.
- **Think before you click**: Links in emails, instant messages or on social media may not be what they seem. Clicking on suspicious links can take you to dangerous websites or cause you to unintentionally download viruses.
- **Update your software:** Keeping your operating system, browser, and other software up to date is crucial to protecting your computer from new threats, as updates often include security fixes.
- By following these simple tips, you can enjoy all the good things the internet has to offer, while staying safe and secure online.

Online Gaming Security

- Playing online is a fun way to stay entertained and make friends, but it's also important to play safely to protect your information and ensure the fun continues. Here are some online gaming safety tips:
- **Use safe nicknames:** When creating your character or profile in games, choose nicknames that do not reveal your real identity. Avoid using your full name, date of birth or any personal information.
- **Strong passwords:** As with other online accounts, use strong and unique passwords for your gaming accounts. A good password contains a combination of letters, numbers and symbols.
- **Be careful with links and downloads:** Be cautious when clicking on links or downloading files within games, especially if they come from people you don't know. They may contain viruses or malware.

Online Gaming Security

- **Privacy Settings:** Adjust your privacy settings in games to control who can see your profile and communicate with you. Limit access to information you don't want to share.
- **Secure communication**: Be careful when sharing personal information with other players. Remember that people online may not be who they say they are.
- **Parental supervision**: For younger players, it is important that parents or guardians are involved. They can help set up accounts, adjust privacy settings, and monitor gaming activities.
- Following these tips can help keep your online gaming experience safe and enjoyable, allowing you to focus on fun and competition in a protected environment.

YOU'RE A
CYBER HERO!